

CUSTOMER REQUEST MANAGEMENT IMPROVEMENT

From operational data to requirements, process redesign and decision support

Independent Case Study / Portfolio Project

Tolomelli Group (fictional) | Sep 2025 - Aug 2026

Requests	On-Time	Overdue	Avg Cycle	Avg Manual
1,200	80.8%	65	4.68 days	41.0 min

PROJECT STORY

A B2B request team showed a sharp deterioration in delivery performance. This case follows the work from baseline analysis and root-cause hypothesis through requirements, future-state design, project controls, Power BI monitoring and a business recommendation.

1. Executive Summary

A 1,200-request dataset revealed a clear recent deterioration in service delivery. During June-August 2026, on-time completion stayed below 70%, average cycle time rose above 5.5 days, and average manual processing effort increased approximately 29% compared with September-May. Resource Availability also became substantially more prominent among recorded delay causes.

The proposed response is not a dashboard-only solution. The case combines process improvement, centralized operational visibility, workload-management capabilities, proactive deadline controls and selective automation. Power BI provides management visibility, while the future-state process addresses assignment, monitoring, escalation and workflow limitations.

2. Project Context & Business Problem

The B2B customer-request process is largely manual. Delayed or frozen requests are difficult to identify quickly; ownership and workload are not always transparent; and assignment, updates, tracking and reporting require recurring manual effort. Management therefore lacks a consolidated view of request status, deadlines, workload distribution and performance trends.

Project Objective

Improve the customer request management process by increasing operational visibility, supporting balanced resource allocation, reducing unnecessary manual effort, and addressing the primary factors associated with request delays.

3. Dataset & Business Rules

Item	Definition
Dataset	1,200 customer requests received Sep 2025-Aug 2026; open-request reference date: Sep 1, 2026.
On Time	Completed_Date <= Due_Date.
Late	Completed_Date > Due_Date.
Overdue	Open request with Due_Date before Sep 1, 2026.
On Track	Open request with Due_Date on or after Sep 1, 2026.
Cycle Time	Completed_Date - Received_Date for completed requests.
On-Time Completion Rate	On-time completed requests / all completed requests; open requests excluded.

4. Baseline & Key Findings

Finding	Evidence	Meaning
Overall baseline	916 On Time; 217 Late; 65 Overdue; 2 On Track	1,133 completed requests; 80.8% overall on-time completion.
Recent deterioration	Jun 67.7%; Jul 66.4%; Aug 68.7%	Final three months remained below 70%.
Cycle time	Jun 5.82; Jul 5.54; Aug 5.59 days	Above historical monthly range of roughly 3.7-4.6 days.
Manual effort	37.7 -> 48.6 min/request	Approximately 29% increase from Sep-May to Jun-Aug.
Delay mix	Resource Availability: 13.6% -> 30.3%	Largest recent shift among recorded problem categories.
Workload	Assignments concentrated more heavily on John in Jun-Aug	Workload distribution changed; this does not establish individual causality.

5. Root Cause Analysis

Evidence chain: on-time completion declined while cycle time, request volume, manual effort per request and Resource Availability delays increased; assignment also became uneven. The working hypothesis is that higher workload combined with higher manual processing requirements created capacity pressure, and that the existing manual process may not scale efficiently as demand increases.

Analytical guardrail: This is a potential root cause, not a proven causal conclusion. The data does not isolate the specific manual activities responsible for the increase, and it does not support blaming an individual owner.

6. Business & Solution Requirements

Business Need	Solution Capabilities
Visibility	Status counts; owner/priority/status filters; cycle time; monthly KPI trends; centralized request record.
Resource Allocation	Workload by owner; reassignment; assignment recommendation with manager approval/override.
Process Efficiency	Automatic overdue identification; automatic KPI updates; proactive deadline alerts; escalation.
Decision Support	Proposed workload score using priority and estimated effort, subject to calibration and validation.

7. Requirements Prioritization & Traceability

Requirements were mapped from identified problems and findings to business requirements, functional requirements, proposed features and validation methods. MoSCoW prioritization kept essential visibility, monitoring and core workflow controls in the Must Have; reassignment, assignment recommendations and escalation were treated as Should Have; the proposed workload score remained a Could Have enhancement pending operational calibration.

8. Future-State Process

Request Received -> Classify -> Estimate Effort -> Evaluate Workload -> Recommend Owner -> Manager Approves/Overrides -> Owner Assigned -> Monitor Due Date -> Alert -> Overdue Flag/Escalation -> Complete -> Update KPIs

Intermediate states may include Waiting for Customer and Approval Pending. Human approval remains part of assignment because skills, availability, continuity and other operational factors may not be captured by a workload model.

9. Scope & Deliverables

In Scope	Out of Scope
Current-state performance and delay analysis	Additional headcount or outsourcing
Requirements, prioritization and future-state design	Enterprise-wide transformation
Workload-management and deadline-control concepts	Full production deployment of a CRM/service platform
Power BI dashboard and KPI validation	Unsupported financial ROI assumptions
PM artifacts, business case and recommendations	

Key Deliverables

Customer Request Performance Analysis; Future-State Process & Requirements Package; Workload & Ownership Management Framework; Power BI Operational Dashboard; selected Project Management artifacts; Business Case & Recommendations; Portfolio Case Study.

10. Stakeholders & Governance

Stakeholder	Engagement	Role
Director of Operations / Sponsor	Manage closely	Authorization, support, escalation and approval.
Operations Manager	Manage closely	Primary operational decision-maker; validates requirements and process design.
Customer Request Team	Actively involve	Operational expertise, requirements feedback and UAT.
PM / Project Coordinator	Lead / coordinate	Scope, schedule, risks, decisions, communication and delivery.
IT / Systems / Data	Engage as needed	Technical feasibility, data, security, automation and dashboard support.

11. Risks, Assumptions & Constraints

Risk	Response
Historical data is incomplete or inaccurate	Validate business rules and reconcile samples.
Users resist or struggle with the new process	Involve users, train, document procedures and phase adoption.
Operational data is not maintained consistently	Use required fields, standardized values, timestamps, validation and exception monitoring.
Customer information/responses arrive late	Define intake requirements, reminders, follow-up rules and escalation.

Open business decision: whether customer-dependent waiting periods should pause SLA measurement. The baseline is not changed without an approved rule.

12. Power BI Dashboard & KPI Validation

The operational dashboard consolidates request volume, completion performance, overdue backlog, cycle time, manual processing effort, workload distribution, delay reasons and status. Filters allow analysis by owner, priority, request type and received month.

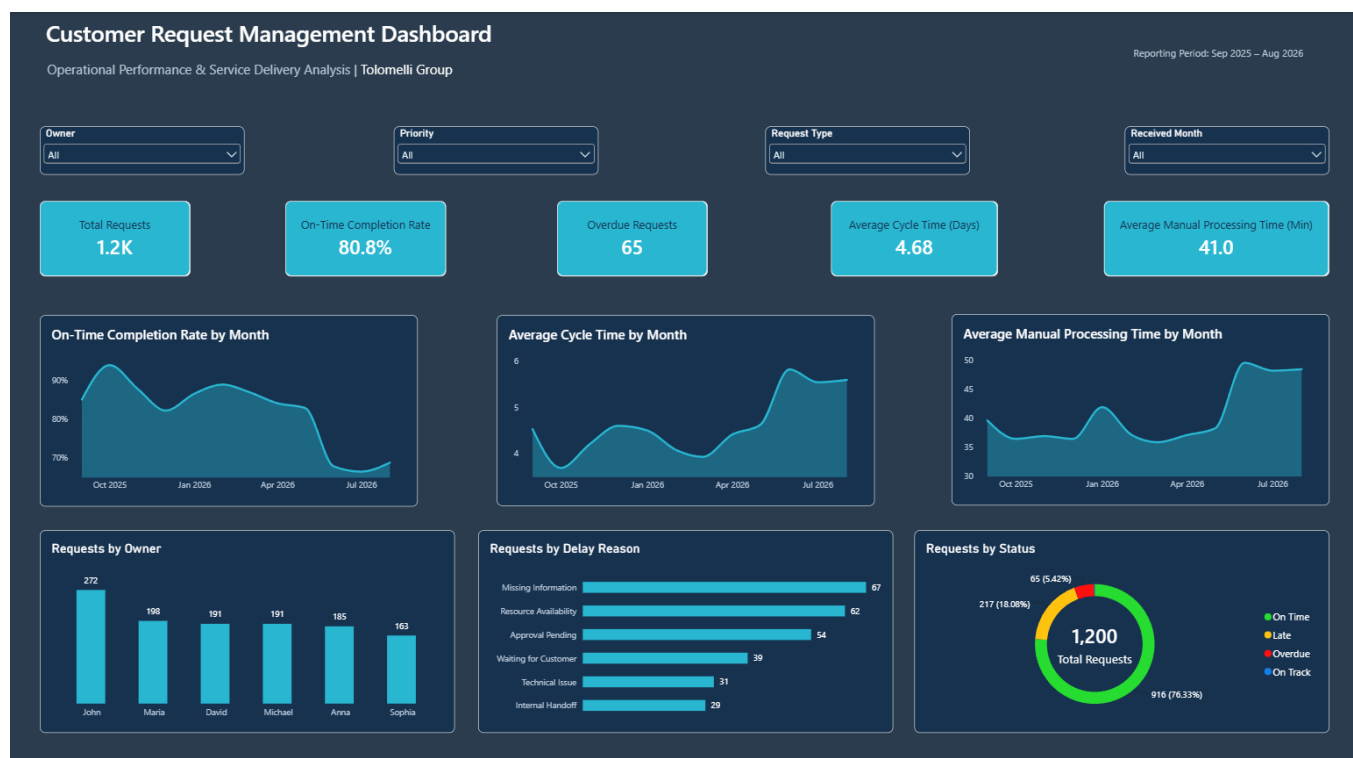


Figure 1. Customer Request Management Dashboard

Dashboard validation: 1,200 total requests; 80.8% on-time completion; 65 overdue requests; 4.68 days average cycle time; 41.0 minutes average manual processing time. Status counts reconcile to 916 On Time, 217 Late, 65 Overdue and 2 On Track.

13. Business Case & Options Analysis

Option	Assessment
A - Maintain Current Process	Minimal immediate implementation effort, but leaves the identified operational limitations and deterioration risk unchanged.
B - Power BI Dashboard Only	Improves visibility, but does not solve assignment, approvals, resource allocation, dependencies or repetitive administrative work.
C - Process Improvement + BI + Selective Automation	Addresses both visibility and process-execution limitations through standardized workflow, workload controls, alerts and targeted automation.

14. Recommended Approach

Recommended approach: Option C — Process Improvement + BI + Selective Automation. The recommendation addresses both management visibility and process-execution limitations. Implementation should move through validation and prototyping before broader deployment.

Expected Benefits

- Higher on-time completion and lower overdue backlog.
- Lower average cycle time and manual processing effort.
- More proactive deadline management and earlier intervention.
- Better-informed workload and resource-allocation decisions.
- A more scalable request-management process and improved service reliability.

15. Implementation Roadmap

Discovery & Baseline -> Requirements & Future State -> Solution Design -> Prototype Development -> Validation & UAT -> Implementation Preparation.

Schedule discipline: The case shows sequencing and dependencies without fabricating an unsupported project duration.

16. Success Criteria & Key Decisions

Success / Decision	Rationale
Document performance gaps and primary delay drivers	Establishes a defensible baseline for solution design.
Trace future-state requirements to business needs	Reduces unsupported scope expansion.
Validate the Power BI dashboard against source data	Protects KPI reliability.
Do not assign causality to individual owners	Owner-level evidence does not support that conclusion.
Do not invent a performance target or financial ROI	Business-approved target, implementation cost and financial-impact data are unavailable.
Keep human approval for assignment recommendations	Operational factors may exist outside the workload model.
Treat Workload Score as proposed	Weighting requires calibration and validation before operational use.

Portfolio Disclosure

This is an independent case study created for portfolio purposes. Tolomelli Group is fictional and is not presented as employment experience. The project demonstrates analysis, requirements, process and solution design, project-management thinking, dashboard development and recommendations; it does not claim a production implementation.